

Tuesday, 29 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 26° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Heavy drizzle 24° 13°	MANCHESTER Overcast 21° 13°	GLASGOW Overcast 18° 9°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Five men arrested in connection with a major incident near RAF Fairford have been released on police bail.

Counter-terror police are leading the investigation, exploring whether individuals working for a foreign state were involved. The vital US airbase in England has long been considered a possible target.

CRIME · UK
- 2

UK diesel prices have hit an all-time high, according to the RAC.

The ongoing US-Israel war with Iran is causing fuel prices to soar globally due to disruptions in oil supplies. This comes as the UK government is also in talks with the US over a potential diesel export ban threatened by Donald Trump.

ECONOMY · UK
- 3

A lithium-ion battery has been confirmed as the cause of a house fire that tragically killed a mother and her three children in Merseyside.

Elisha Brabin, 36, and her children died in the blaze at their home in Bootle. This devastating incident highlights the dangers associated with these types of batteries.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 4

The Home Secretary, Mahmood, is signalling a potential rethink on proposals concerning migrants' right to remain in the UK.

This comes after pressure from some Labour MPs, including Angela Rayner, to water down the original plans. Mahmood is also set to reopen a scheme to resettle refugees in the UK.

POLITICS · UK
- 5

New cameras have revealed thousands of illegal 'ghost plates' on cars across the UK, raising serious safety concerns.

These illicit registration plates are reportedly far too easy to acquire. Experts warn they are putting the public at risk by making it harder to identify vehicles involved in crimes.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 **Get ready for more backstabbing and intrigue as 'Celebrity Traitors' returns to our screens this Thursday!**

Twenty-one stars will be vying for the £100,000 prize for their chosen charity. It's always a talking point, with fans already speculating about who the 'big dogs' and 'dark horses' will be.

ON AIR – Who do you think will be the ultimate Traitor, or the most faithful Faithful?

TV · THIS WEEK

2 **The classic TV show 'Our Friends in the North' is getting a new lease of life with a stage version, and its writer says it's still incredibly relevant.**

Peter Flannery believes the themes explored in the original series will resonate strongly with modern audiences. It's a chance for a new generation to discover this much-loved drama.

ON AIR – What classic TV shows do you think would work brilliantly as a stage play?

THEATRE · COMING UP

3 **Catherine Zeta-Jones is basing her latest acting role on the funny Welsh people she knows!**

She's playing Jackie Price, a former cocaine dealer targeted by assassins in the new project 'Kill Jackie'. It sounds like she's bringing some authentic Welsh humour to the character.

ON AIR – Which regional accents or characteristics do you love to see portrayed on screen?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **Irish rock legends U2 have celebrated their 50th anniversary by going back to their roots.**

The band played a special gig in the Dublin playground where they first met and formed. It's a wonderful way to mark such a huge milestone in their incredible career.

ON AIR – If your favourite band could play a gig anywhere, where would you want it to be?

MUSIC · PAST

5 **Jorja Smith says she's 'very grateful' after picking up a prestigious independent music prize.**

The singer reflected on her 'crazy' journey as she collected the award for best independent track. It's fantastic to see independent artists getting this kind of recognition.

ON AIR – Who are your favourite independent artists making waves right now?

MUSIC · PAST

On the schedule

1 **After more than two years, a judgement finally appears to have been made on the 115 charges against Manchester City.**

The club has reportedly been found guilty of breaking the majority of the Premier League's financial rules. This ruling could have significant implications for the club, with talk of potential sanctions.

ON AIR – What do you think would be a fair punishment for Manchester City, if they are found guilty?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Wales suffered a 2-0 defeat to Denmark in Copenhagen in their latest Nations League match.**

The result will be a disappointment for Rob Page's side as they push for qualification. Craig Bellamy, however, insists Wales have earned their place in Nations League A.

ON AIR – How do you think Wales will bounce back from this defeat in their next game?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **England's Nations League squad faces potential injury concerns ahead of their clash with the Czech Republic on Tuesday night.**

Ezri Konsa and Nico O'Reilly are both doubts for the match. Gareth Southgate will be hoping they can recover in time for the important fixture.

ON AIR – Who would you bring in to replace Konsa and O'Reilly if they can't play?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Ronnie O'Sullivan has been knocked out of the Shenzhen Open on the opening day.**

The seven-time world champion was among several big names to exit early, including world number one Zhao Xintong. It's an unexpected start to the tournament for some of the sport's biggest stars.

ON AIR – Are you surprised to see so many top players out of the Shenzhen Open so early?

SNOOKER · THIS WEEK

5 **Preston North End have appointed Bradford City boss Graham Alexander as their new manager.**

Alexander leaves the Bantams to take up the role at Deepdale. Fans will be eager to see what he brings to the club and how he plans to turn their fortunes around.

ON AIR – What do you think Graham Alexander needs to do first to make an impact at Preston?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The delightful trend of 'community book swaps' in public spaces is fostering a wonderful sense of local connection.**
People are setting up small, free libraries in parks and on street corners, encouraging neighbours to share their favourite reads and discover new ones. It's a lovely way to recycle books and build community spirit.
- 2 Experts are praising the simple joy of 'writing handwritten letters' as a powerful way to de-stress and connect deeply.**
In our fast-paced digital world, taking the time to craft a personal letter can be incredibly therapeutic. The recipient also gets a unique, tangible keepsake, which feels rather special.
- 3 A new study reveals that 'watching documentaries about nature' can significantly boost feelings of calm and well-being.**
Researchers found that immersing oneself in the natural world through screens, particularly with soothing narratives, helps reduce stress and promotes a more positive outlook. It's like a mini-escape to the wilderness from your sofa!
- 4 The charming practice of 'decorating garden gnomes with tiny, themed accessories' is adding a quirky touch to outdoor spaces.**
From miniature hats to tiny tools, garden gnome enthusiasts are getting creative, giving their garden guardians unique personalities. It certainly brings a smile to passers-by!
- 5 Researchers are highlighting the surprising benefits of 'having a designated 'thinking chair' at home' for sparking creativity.**
Having a specific spot dedicated to quiet contemplation, away from distractions, can help unlock new ideas and allow your mind to wander productively. Perhaps it's time to find your own 'thinking chair'!
- 6 The delightful art of 'crafting homemade greetings cards' is seeing a resurgence amongst those looking for a personal touch.**
Moving beyond mass-produced options, people are enjoying the creative process of making unique cards for friends and family. It adds an extra layer of warmth and thoughtfulness to any occasion.
- 7 A report indicates that 'taking a regular 'digital detox' walk in a local park' is becoming a popular way to recharge.**
Stepping away from screens and enjoying a stroll amidst greenery helps to clear the mind and offers a much-needed break from constant notifications. It's a simple, effective way to reset.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of biscuits, especially if it's a fancy selection. What is it?
- ANSWER:** REARRANGING THEM SO ALL THE BEST ONES ARE AT THE TOP, JUST IN CASE!
- Q** Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?
- ANSWER:** GIVING THE BOX A LITTLE SHAKE TO HEAR THE 'CRUNCH POTENTIAL'!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of flower' just instantly brings back happy memories of a special person or a lovely garden you once visited, even if you haven't seen that flower in ages?
Perhaps it's the scent, the colour, or just the sight of it that transports you back. What flower has that special power for you, and what memory does it conjure?
- We all have that 'one small, everyday household ritual' that, no matter how busy things get, you always try to make time for because it genuinely makes your home feel more organised or cosy, don't we?
Maybe it's making your bed perfectly each morning, watering your plants, or lighting a specific candle. What's that comforting little ritual for you, and why do you love it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is wonderfully known as a 'parliament'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Baby puffins are called 'pufflings' and spend their early lives learning to 'fish jump' off cliffs.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest commercially available car is the Peel P50, which weighs just 59 kilograms.
- The Great Wall of China is not a single continuous wall, but rather a series of fortifications built across different dynasties.
- Bumblebees have 'furry' bodies that help them stay warm and carry pollen.
- The smell of freshly cut grass is actually a plant distress signal.
- It is illegal to sing out of tune in Maryland, USA.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- The British Royal Family officially owns all the swans on certain stretches of the River Thames.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.

On this day

Day 272 of the year, 93 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles, Duke of Brittany; Christian feast day: Cyriacus the Anchorite; Christian feast day: Hripsime; Christian feast day: Blessed Francisc de Paula Castelló Aleu. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1957 — Chris Broad, English cricketer and referee
- 1976 — Darren Byfield, English-Jamaican footballer
- 1994 — Halsey, American singer
- 1973 — Alfie Boe, English tenor and actor
- 1962 — Roger Bart, American actor
- 1966 — Ben Miles, English actor
- 1970 — Emily Lloyd, English actress
- 1966 — Jill Whelan, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1975 — WGPR becomes the first black-owned-and-operated television station in the US.
- 1954 — The convention establishing CERN (the European Organization for Nuclear Research) is signed.
- 2004 — The asteroid 4179 Toutatis passes within four lunar distances of Earth.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2019 — Violence and low turnout mar the 2019 Afghan presidential election.
- 1971 — Oman joins the Arab League.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2006 — A Boeing 737 and an Embraer 600 collide in mid-air, killing 154 people and triggering a Brazilian aviation crisis.
- 1959 — A Lockheed L-188 Electra crashes in Buffalo, Texas, killing 34 people.
- 1975 — WGPR becomes the first black-owned-and-operated television station in the US.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 273 of the year, 92 days left in 2026. Today Agricultural Reform (Nationalization) Day (São Tomé and Príncipe); Birth of Morelos (Mexico); Blasphemy Day, educates individuals and groups about blasphemy laws and defends freedom of expression; Boy's Day (Poland). Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1992 — Ezra Miller, American actor and singer
- 1962 — Marley Marl, American record producer and rapper
- 1958 — Marty Stuart, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1944 — Jimmy Johnstone, Scottish footballer (died 2006)
- 1966 — Gary Armstrong, Scottish rugby player
- 1967 — Gibby Haynes, American musician, radio personality and painter
- 1940 — Dewey Martin, Canadian-American drummer (died 2009)
- 1957 — Fran Drescher, American actress, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1939 — World War II: General Władysław Sikorski becomes prime minister of the Polish government-in-exile.
- 2016 — Two paintings with a combined value of \$100 million are recovered after having been stolen from the Van Gogh Museum in 2002.
- 1975 — Malév Flight 240 crashes into the Mediterranean Sea while on approach to Beirut International Airport in Beirut, Lebanon, killing 60.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1968 — The Boeing 747 is rolled out and shown to the public for the first time.
- 1966 — Bechuanaland declares its independence, and becomes the Republic of Botswana.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar